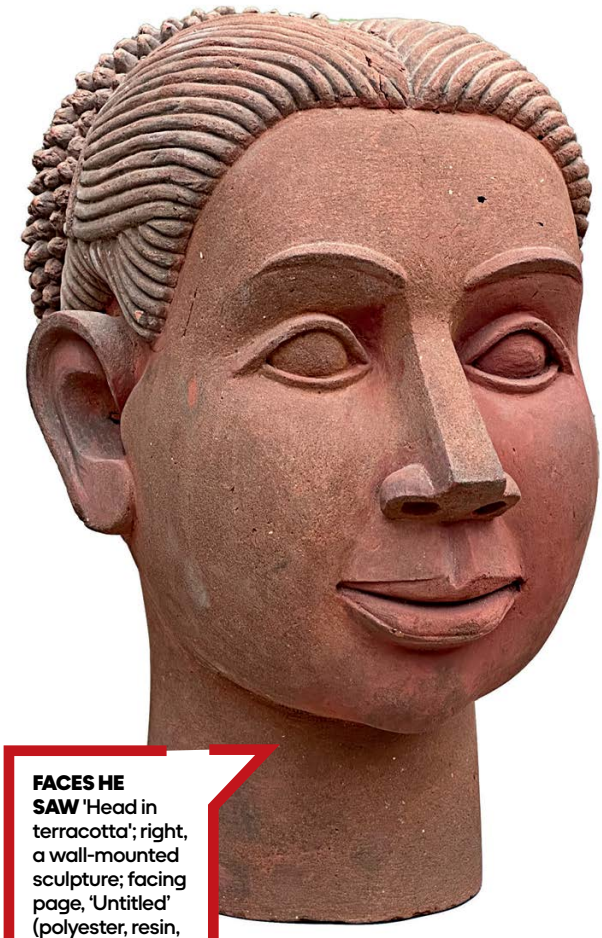
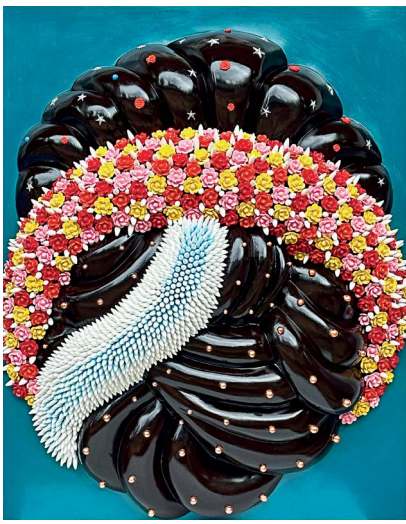


FACES HE SAW 'Head in terracotta'; right, a wall-mounted sculpture; facing page, 'Untitled' (polyester, resin, fibreglass)

During G. Ravinder Reddy's childhood years, a career in the field of arts was not only uncommon but often frowned upon. For the farming community in Andhra Pradesh that he came from, academics and a secure job thereafter were the preferred path. So, it seemed unlikely that Reddy would eventually go on to become one of India's most recognisable contemporary sculptors. Yet, a natural love for the arts always beckoned and a deep dive into studying its various forms resulted in a journey that spans decades, geographies, materials and dimensions.

Reddy's own description of his practice is surprisingly modest. "I see myself as a traditional potter and a clay modeller who physically models different ideas. I work with clay and then transform the work into materials such as fibreglass, terracotta and metal," he shares.

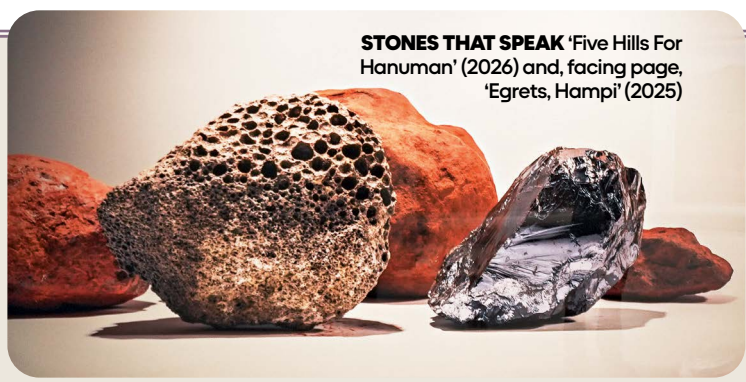
His life and work have now come full circle as they are being revisited through *In Search of the Perfect Image*, his first solo exhibition in India in nearly a decade. Presented by Gallery Sumukha in Bengaluru as it celebrates its 30th anniversary, the



EXHIBITION ▼

A SECOND LOOK AT HAMPI

ATUL BHALLA AND **ROBERT ZHAO RENHUI** WALKED HAMPI'S LANDSCAPES TOGETHER, YET EMERGED WITH DIFFERENT WORLDS SHAPED BY MEMORY AND OBSERVATION



STONES THAT SPEAK 'Five Hills For Hanuman' (2026) and, facing page, 'Egrets, Hampi' (2025)

An artistic banter between a couple of creatives, who have lived in and through a landscape and have interpreted it, proves that there is no single truth or reality, and that one is not superior to the other. A year ago, visual artists Atul Bhalla and Robert Zhao Renhui from Singapore spent two months in and around Hampi, a UNESCO World Heritage Site, as artists-in-residence at Hampi Art Labs by the JSW Foundation, in Vidyanagar Township in Karnataka. It was undertaken as part of the inaugural collaboration between Hampi Art Labs and The Institutum, a Singapore-based non-profit institution.

The duo travelled by road and on foot through the Tungabhadra Basin—from Vidyanagar Township to Hampi—visiting sites like the Tungabhadra Dam and Kamalapur Lake. There emerged two distinct ways of looking at the same world, as Bhalla and Zhao